

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Medical Devices English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders.

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 User need to design input

02 Risk review

03 Verification versus validation

04 Formative usability findings

05 Submission planning

06 Complaint intake

07 Supplier nonconformance

08 Training within labeling

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

User need to design input

A device team reviews a vague usability requirement.

Roles: Product manager / Systems engineer

Product manager: Users want the display to be readable at a glance. How do we turn that into a design input?

Systems engineer: Define the intended users, viewing conditions, information, and a measurable acceptance criterion.

Product manager: Can we reuse the criterion from our desktop product?

Systems engineer: Not without checking the use environment. This device will be used under different lighting and workflow conditions.

Product manager: I'll bring those user-research findings to the requirements review.

Systems engineer: Then we can agree on traceable inputs and an appropriate verification approach.

Notice the professional language

design input - A documented requirement that guides a product's design.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Risk review

A team discusses an alarm that users sometimes miss.

Roles: Risk engineer / Human factors specialist

Risk engineer: The hazard analysis lists a missed alarm. Is a louder tone sufficient as a control?

Human factors specialist: We need to examine the use scenario and contributing factors before deciding that.

Risk engineer: Users reported competing alarms and difficulty identifying which device was sounding.

Human factors specialist: Then recognition and workflow matter as well as volume. Let's review the observations and proposed controls together.

Risk engineer: I'll update the risk file with the evidence and open questions.

Human factors specialist: I'll define the usability questions that the next evaluation needs to address.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The hazard analysis lists a missed alarm. Is a louder tone sufficient as a control?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Verification versus validation

A project team reviews a test-completion claim.

Roles: Project manager / Quality engineer

Project manager: All bench tests passed. Can we say validation is complete?

Quality engineer: The bench tests address specified design inputs. Validation addresses intended use and user needs under the planned conditions.

Project manager: So the verification results don't automatically close the validation activities?

Quality engineer: Correct. The traceability matrix still shows open usability and intended-use evidence.

Project manager: I'll separate the two statuses in the milestone report.

Quality engineer: Let's review the approved plans and record exactly which acceptance criteria remain open.

Notice the professional language

acceptance criteria - Specific conditions a deliverable must meet to be accepted.

intended use - The purpose for which a product is designed and represented to be used.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Formative usability findings

A designer and human factors specialist review a simulated-use session.

Roles: Human factors specialist / Interface designer

Human factors specialist: Three participants selected the wrong menu before finding the setting. They recovered without assistance.

Interface designer: Can we classify that as successful task completion and move on?

Human factors specialist: Completion matters, but the use difficulties still need analysis. We should examine potential consequences in the intended workflow.

Interface designer: I'll compare the screen labels and navigation paths from the observations.

Human factors specialist: Keep observed behavior separate from our explanation of why it happened.

Interface designer: I'll prepare design options for the next review rather than assume a label change solves it.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Can we classify that as successful task completion and move on?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Submission planning

A regulatory lead questions a launch assumption.

Roles: Product manager / Regulatory affairs lead

Product manager: A similar device reached market recently. Can we use the same regulatory pathway?

Regulatory affairs lead: Similarity alone doesn't establish the appropriate pathway. Intended use, technology, claims, and jurisdiction all need review.

Product manager: What information do you need to assess it?

Regulatory affairs lead: The current device description, intended-use statement, risk information, and comparison evidence.

Product manager: I'll assemble those and keep the launch date provisional.

Regulatory affairs lead: I'll document the assessment and identify any questions requiring further regulatory clarification.

Notice the professional language

intended use - The purpose for which a product is designed and represented to be used.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Complaint intake

A service report enters the complaint process.

Roles: Service engineer / Complaint specialist

Service engineer: A customer says the device stopped during use. I have the serial number but not the event time.

Complaint specialist: Record what they reported and seek the missing details through the complaint process.

Service engineer: Should I call it operator error? The settings may have been wrong.

Complaint specialist: That's not established. Separate observations from hypotheses and preserve the available logs.

Service engineer: I'll provide the service history and route the report promptly.

Complaint specialist: I'll coordinate the required complaint and reportability assessment; service troubleshooting doesn't replace that review.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Should I call it operator error? The settings may have been wrong." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Supplier nonconformance

A receiving inspection finds an out-of-specification component.

Roles: Supplier quality engineer / Manufacturing lead

Supplier quality engineer: The connector lot failed dimensional inspection. It's on hold under the nonconformance record.

Manufacturing lead: Can we use selected parts if they appear to fit?

Supplier quality engineer: Any sorting, rework, or use decision needs an approved disposition and defined acceptance criteria.

Manufacturing lead: Production needs to know the supply impact today.

Supplier quality engineer: I'll confirm the affected quantity and ask engineering and quality to review the options.

Manufacturing lead: I'll revise the schedule using approved stock and keep held material out of production.

Notice the professional language

acceptance criteria - Specific conditions a deliverable must meet to be accepted.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Training within labeling

A clinical trainer receives a request beyond approved instructions.

Roles: Clinical trainer / Medical affairs colleague

Clinical trainer: A user asked how to adapt the device for a use outside the current labeling.

Medical affairs colleague: Don't improvise operating instructions. Route the question through the approved medical-information process.

Clinical trainer: I can explain the labeled workflow and record the separate question accurately.

Medical affairs colleague: Yes. Keep the user's wording and relevant context without suggesting that an unreviewed use is approved.

Clinical trainer: I'll send the inquiry to the designated team and confirm the response route.

Medical affairs colleague: I'll help ensure the follow-up follows our current labeling and communication procedures.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "A user asked how to adapt the device for a use outside the current labeling." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

User Needs and Design Inputs

SHARED CASE

A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

SHARED CASE

A risk discussion uses hazard and harm interchangeably. The team needs to describe the potential source of harm and the possible outcome separately.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Let's distinguish the hazard from the harm that could result. That will help us describe the sequence clearly and discuss the controls without treating the two terms as synonyms.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Verification, Validation, and Design Review

SHARED CASE

A device team has checked design outputs against specifications but has not yet completed the planned evaluation of intended user needs.

Role A | Responding professional

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Useful expressions

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Cover this until after your first attempt

The specification checks address verification. They do not by themselves answer every validation question about intended use. I'll report those activities separately and identify what remains open.

Second round

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Usability and Human Factors

SHARED CASE

Several participants misread a label in a formative usability study. A draft report describes them as careless.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The observed difficulty was reading the label correctly in this study. Let's describe the task, design, and use conditions, then investigate contributing factors without assuming carelessness.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

SHARED CASE

A presentation refers to a proposed device pathway as settled, although the regulatory team is still evaluating options.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Cover this until after your first attempt

Please label the pathway as under evaluation and identify the questions for the regulatory team. We should distinguish a proposed approach from a confirmed regulatory conclusion.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

SHARED CASE

A complaint report describes a malfunction but lacks the device identifier and event date. The complaint-handling team needs the available facts promptly.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Cover this until after your first attempt

Here is the reported malfunction and the information currently available. The device identifier and event date are missing. Please confirm receipt and handle follow-up through the complaint process.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

SHARED CASE

An incoming-material review has identified two nonconforming lots. The investigation is open and disposition has not been authorized.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

Two lots have open nonconformance records. The investigation and disposition are still pending. I'll report their status without implying that release or rejection has already been approved.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

SHARED CASE

A trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the materials approved for the session.

Role A | Responding professional

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You want to move quickly and initially overlook a relevant condition. Ask why it matters, then consider a practical route forward that respects the real constraint.

Useful expressions

I understand the goal. My concern is

That statement goes beyond

Could we ... before confirming ...?

Cover this until after your first attempt

That request goes beyond the approved training material for this session. I can cover the authorized instructions and route the additional question to the appropriate team for review.

Second round

The other person repeats the request more firmly. Restate the specific concern calmly and explain the appropriate next route.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Easy to use for whom?

Fictional design-planning meeting: the brief says easy to use but names neither intended users nor the use environment.

01 • Design engineer: The brief says easy to use. Which intended users and environment does that refer to?

02 • Product manager: Those details haven't been defined, so I can't turn that phrase into a reliable design input yet.

03 • Design engineer: Could we assume trained hospital staff, since that would make the requirement easier to draft?

04 • Product manager: No. That would invent a user group and potentially change the intended-use assumptions.

05 • Design engineer: What should we clarify first with the team that supplied the user need?

06 • Product manager: Who performs the task, what task they perform, and the conditions in which they do it.

07 • Design engineer: Then we can discuss measurable design inputs rather than treating easy as a test criterion.

08 • Product manager: Exactly. Keep traceability from the clarified user need to any proposed requirement.

09 • Design engineer: I'll bring those focused questions to the design meeting and leave the input marked unresolved.

10 • Product manager: I'll identify the appropriate user-research source so the team can confirm the scope before drafting acceptance criteria.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A readable screen under which conditions?

Separate fictional device case: a portable reader is intended for trained technicians in a bright clinic room; the brief says readable without specifying distance or display content.

01 • Human factors specialist: We know the users and room conditions. What does readable mean for this portable reader?

02 • Design engineer: The brief doesn't specify viewing distance or which displayed information the technician must distinguish.

03 • Human factors specialist: Could we ask users about the task before choosing a text size as the design input?

04 • Design engineer: Yes. A size selected without task context may not address the actual user need.

05 • Human factors specialist: Should the requirement cover every possible outdoor condition as well as the clinic?

06 • Design engineer: That isn't the supplied intended environment. Any scope expansion needs an explicit review, not an assumption.

07 • Human factors specialist: I'll clarify the viewing task, content, and distance with the intended users.

08 • Design engineer: I'll keep the proposed requirement linked to those findings for traceability.

09 • Human factors specialist: Then our next discussion can address a testable input without promising universal readability.

10 • Design engineer: Agreed. We'll document the confirmed environment and leave untested conditions outside the claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A user preference mistaken for an approved input

Separate fictional design review: one technician requested a larger carrying handle; no broader user assessment or approved design input exists.

01 • Product owner: A technician asked for a larger handle. Can we mark that as an approved design input?

02 • Systems engineer: It's a useful user comment, but we haven't assessed the need or approved a requirement.

03 • Product owner: What question would help us understand whether size is the actual problem?

04 • Systems engineer: Ask which carrying task is difficult and under what conditions the current handle causes difficulty.

05 • Product owner: Could the request reflect a personal preference rather than a need shared by every user?

06 • Systems engineer: Possibly. We shouldn't assume either interpretation before reviewing the evidence and intended-use context.

07 • Product owner: I'll preserve the original comment and request a focused follow-up instead of promising a redesign.

08 • Systems engineer: Good. Traceability should show how a reviewed need leads to an input, not just copy a suggestion.

09 • Product owner: I'll bring the clarified task to the design discussion and identify what remains unknown.

10 • Systems engineer: Then we can evaluate options against the actual need without treating one proposed solution as already authorized.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | User Needs and Design Inputs

A design brief says the device should be "easy to use." It does not identify the intended users or use environment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Who will use it, for which task, and in what environment? Let's turn "easy to use" into specific user needs and requirements that the team can review.

Scenario 2 | A one-handed requirement without a task

A fictional design brief requests one-handed operation but does not specify which task or why one hand is occupied. The intended users are clinic technicians. Clarify the task before proposing a design input.

Role A: Design engineer: ask which operation must be performed and under what conditions.

Role B: Product specialist: distinguish the stated request from information that still needs user research.

Possible opening: Which task needs one-handed operation, and what is the technician doing with the other hand?

Success checks

- Clarify the task and use conditions.
- Avoid expanding the intended requirement without evidence.
- Agree how the verified need will connect to a testable design input.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to apply the requirement to every device interaction.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Hazard and harm are not interchangeable

Fictional risk-language exercise: a design worksheet mixes the potential source of harm with the possible resulting injury; no operational safety instructions are practiced.

01 • Risk facilitator: Our worksheet uses hazard and harm as if they mean the same thing. Can we separate them?

02 • Design engineer: A hazard is a potential source of harm; harm is the possible injury or damage.

03 • Risk facilitator: Could we use a hypothetical hot surface and burn to make the distinction concrete?

04 • Design engineer: Yes. The hot surface is the source; a burn is a possible harmful outcome.

05 • Risk facilitator: Does naming both establish that a burn has actually occurred in this device project?

06 • Design engineer: No. This is a hypothetical analysis, not a report of an observed event.

07 • Risk facilitator: Where does residual risk fit when we discuss the proposed risk controls?

08 • Design engineer: It concerns risk remaining after controls; we still need the relevant evaluation rather than assume zero risk.

09 • Risk facilitator: I'll revise the FMEA discussion so the source, sequence, and outcome are distinct.

10 • Design engineer: I'll check the terminology without treating this language example as a completed device-risk assessment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A failure mode is not the resulting injury

Separate fictional FMEA exercise: a display could freeze, an operator could read an outdated value, and an inappropriate decision is a possible downstream consequence; likelihoods are unknown.

01 • Reliability engineer: The worksheet lists display freeze as the injury. That seems to mix different parts of the sequence.

02 • Risk manager: Correct. Display freeze is the proposed failure mode, not an injury by itself.

03 • Reliability engineer: The operator might read an outdated value. Is that the same as proving a harmful outcome?

04 • Risk manager: No. It is part of a potential sequence; the possible consequence needs separate description and assessment.

05 • Reliability engineer: Could we assign a low probability because no event figures are supplied in this exercise?

06 • Risk manager: Missing figures don't establish low likelihood. Keep that information unknown until assessed.

07 • Reliability engineer: I'll separate the failure mode, the use situation, and potential harm in the discussion.

08 • Risk manager: Good. An FMEA can support analysis, but naming a failure doesn't complete the entire risk evaluation.

09 • Reliability engineer: We'll also avoid claiming a proposed control eliminates every downstream possibility.

10 • Risk manager: Agreed. Residual risk needs review after the relevant controls and their evidence are considered.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A control proposed versus a control shown effective

Separate fictional design meeting: a warning label is proposed as a risk control, but no evaluation of its effectiveness has been completed.

01 • Project manager: We added a warning label to the proposal. Can the risk item be called closed?

02 • Risk engineer: A proposed control and an effective control are different statuses; its effectiveness hasn't been evaluated.

03 • Project manager: The label mentions the hazard clearly. Doesn't that remove the possibility of harm?

04 • Risk engineer: We can't infer that. We need to assess the control and any residual risk in context.

05 • Project manager: How should I explain the distinction without making a technical claim about all warning labels?

06 • Risk engineer: Say this control is proposed for review, and its effectiveness is not yet established for this device.

07 • Project manager: Could the design team identify what evidence the risk reviewers need next?

08 • Risk engineer: Yes. Ask for the evaluation plan and acceptance basis through the established design process.

09 • Project manager: I'll leave the risk status open and separate the design action from the assessment outcome.

10 • Risk engineer: I'll coordinate the review so the update reflects evidence, not just the existence of additional text.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Risk Management and Hazard Analysis

A risk discussion uses hazard and harm interchangeably. The team needs to describe the potential source of harm and the possible outcome separately.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Let's distinguish the hazard from the harm that could result. That will help us describe the sequence clearly and discuss the controls without treating the two terms as synonyms.

Scenario 2 | An event count without an exposure count

A fictional post-design risk discussion mentions two reported incidents but gives no number of devices or uses. The team wants to describe the probability of harm as low. Discuss the missing basis for that statement.

Role A: Risk analyst: explain what the incident count does and does not establish.

Role B: Design manager: ask for the relevant exposure and event definitions before interpreting likelihood.

Possible opening: Two reports tell us the count, but not the probability without an appropriate exposure basis.

Success checks

- Separate event count from probability.
- Do not treat absent reports as proof of zero risk.
- Agree the evidence needed for the risk review.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to enter zero residual risk because no additional reports are known.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Specifications checked, user needs still under evaluation

Fictional design review: outputs have been checked against specifications; the planned evaluation of intended user needs is incomplete.

01 • Design manager: We've checked the outputs against specifications. Can we cancel the remaining user-needs evaluation to save time?

02 • Validation lead: Those activities address different questions. Verification checks specifications; validation addresses intended needs in the relevant use context.

03 • Design manager: How should we compare the value of the completed tests and the planned evaluation?

04 • Validation lead: Against their respective objectives and acceptance criteria, not by treating either as a substitute for the other.

05 • Design manager: The remaining evaluation takes longer. Could we call the faster route equally complete?

06 • Validation lead: No. The time saving would leave an identified evidence gap rather than establish equivalent coverage.

07 • Design manager: I'll present completed verification separately and keep the validation activity in the review plan.

08 • Validation lead: Please specify which user-needs questions remain open so the schedule discussion has a concrete basis.

09 • Design manager: I'll ask the design-review team to assess the options without declaring the device fully validated.

10 • Validation lead: Good. We can compare timing and evidence coverage while preserving the different purposes of the work.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Bench timing versus task completion with users

Separate fictional planning case: a bench test measures button response time; a proposed user study measures whether technicians complete the intended setup task.

01 • Test engineer: The bench test is quick. Could we use it instead of the technician setup study?

02 • Human factors lead: It measures button response time, while the study addresses completion of the intended user task.

03 • Test engineer: Both involve the same button. Why aren't their acceptance criteria interchangeable?

04 • Human factors lead: A responsive button doesn't establish that users understand when and how to use it in the task.

05 • Test engineer: How can we compare the two activities fairly when management asks which one to fund?

06 • Human factors lead: Show the question each addresses, evidence coverage, effort, and unresolved gaps if an activity is deferred.

07 • Test engineer: Could we report bench verification complete while leaving the user-task evidence pending?

08 • Human factors lead: Yes, if those statuses match the records. Don't call the pending evidence a passing validation result.

09 • Test engineer: I'll bring that comparison to design review and avoid ranking the options by duration alone.

10 • Human factors lead: I'll identify the intended-user questions so the decision maker sees the actual tradeoff.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A changed criterion breaks a simple pass-rate comparison

Separate fictional verification review: revision A used one acceptance criterion, while revision B uses a different criterion; both have reported pass percentages.

01 • Quality manager: Revision B has a higher pass percentage. Can we say its design is better verified?

02 • Verification engineer: The acceptance criteria changed, so the percentages don't provide a like-for-like comparison.

03 • Quality manager: Could we ignore the change because both reports use the word pass?

04 • Verification engineer: No. Pass means meeting the criterion used in that test, and those criteria differ.

05 • Quality manager: What comparison would let the design-review team understand actual progress and remaining coverage?

06 • Verification engineer: Map the requirements and criteria across revisions, then identify comparable tests and changed evidence needs.

07 • Quality manager: Would rerunning everything be the only possible response to the difference?

08 • Verification engineer: We haven't assessed that. The authorized review should determine the needed work from the changes.

09 • Quality manager: I'll qualify the percentages and ask for a requirement-level comparison before presenting an improvement claim.

10 • Verification engineer: I'll show the differences and uncertainties without treating a higher headline rate as proof of broader validation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Verification, Validation, and Design Review

A device team has checked design outputs against specifications but has not yet completed the planned evaluation of intended user needs.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The specification checks address verification. They do not by themselves answer every validation question about intended use. I'll report those activities separately and identify what remains open.

Scenario 2 | Remote and in-person evaluation plans

A fictional device team compares remote and in-person formative evaluation. Remote sessions save travel time, but the proposed remote setup does not reproduce the intended clinic workspace. No equivalence evidence exists. Discuss the scope and tradeoff.

Role A: Study coordinator: explain the practical advantages and missing environmental coverage.

Role B: Validation manager: ask which study questions each setup can address before recommending a plan.

Possible opening: Remote sessions reduce travel, but this setup doesn't reproduce the intended workspace.

Success checks

- Compare plans against the same intended questions.
- Keep environmental limitations explicit.
- Avoid claiming equivalence or final validation from an unassessed plan.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants both plans labeled equivalent validation options without review.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Misread labels without calling participants careless

Fictional formative usability review: several participants misread a label, but the report supplies no evidence about motivation or attentiveness.

01 • Usability researcher: The draft says participants were careless. Our observation was that several misread the label.

02 • Design lead: Could carelessness be a reasonable explanation for the use error in this formative study?

03 • Usability researcher: It is an untested interpretation, not an observed fact. We should investigate the interaction and context.

04 • Design lead: What description would help the team act without assigning blame to the participants?

05 • Usability researcher: State which label was misread, during which task, and what the participants actually did.

06 • Design lead: Those detailed observations need checking against the study records before we add them.

07 • Usability researcher: Exactly. Don't invent the sequence or a cause just to complete the paragraph.

08 • Design lead: Could we already describe this as a failed summative study because use errors occurred?

09 • Usability researcher: No. This was formative work, and its purpose and evidence must be described accurately.

10 • Design lead: I'll remove the blame language and request the observed task details for a focused human-factors review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Four pauses are an observation, not a diagnosis of confusion

Separate fictional formative study: four of eight technicians paused before selecting a menu item; interviews about their reasons are not yet reviewed.

01 • Product manager: Four of eight technicians paused. Can we say half the users were confused by the menu?

02 • Human factors researcher: We observed pauses, but haven't reviewed their explanations. Confusion is not yet established.

03 • Product manager: Would the timing alone show that the interface caused the hesitation during the task?

04 • Human factors researcher: It identifies behavior to investigate, not the cause by itself.

05 • Product manager: How should the finding describe the sample without generalizing to every intended user?

06 • Human factors researcher: Say four of eight participants in this formative study paused before selection, with reasons still under review.

07 • Product manager: Could we pair that observation with the interview evidence once you've checked it?

08 • Human factors researcher: Yes. Keep participant reports distinct from observed actions and our interpretation.

09 • Product manager: I'll remove the half of all users headline and preserve the actual study count.

10 • Human factors researcher: I'll review the accounts and identify which design questions are supported, without assuming a particular use-error mechanism.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Moderator help limits an unaided-success claim

Separate fictional usability session: one participant completed a setup task after the moderator gave a hint; unaided completion was not observed for that attempt.

01 • Study coordinator: The participant finished the task. Can I count this attempt as unaided success?

02 • Usability specialist: No. The moderator gave a hint, so the completion occurred with assistance.

03 • Study coordinator: The hint was short. Could we leave it out because the participant performed the final action?

04 • Usability specialist: That would remove context relevant to interpretation. Record both the assistance and the observed completion.

05 • Study coordinator: Does the assisted attempt prove that every user would fail without help?

06 • Usability specialist: No. That broader conclusion isn't supported by this single formative observation.

07 • Study coordinator: I'll label the attempt assisted and preserve the moderator's wording in the study record.

08 • Usability specialist: Good. Any summary should follow the study's definitions rather than silently change the success category.

09 • Study coordinator: Should we discuss the unanswered unaided-task question at the next human-factors review?

10 • Usability specialist: Yes. Identify the evidence gap and appropriate follow-up without relabeling this attempt as a summative validation result.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Usability and Human Factors

Several participants misread a label in a formative usability study. A draft report describes them as careless.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The observed difficulty was reading the label correctly in this study. Let's describe the task, design, and use conditions, then investigate contributing factors without assuming carelessness.

Scenario 2 | A corrected click after a wrong selection

In a fictional formative study, a participant selects the wrong menu item, notices it, and corrects the selection without help. The draft says no use errors occurred. Discuss how to preserve both the error and recovery.

Role A: Usability observer: describe the observed sequence without attributing a cause.

Role B: Design reviewer: ask how recovery should be represented under the study definitions.

Possible opening: The participant recovered independently, but the initial wrong selection still occurred.

Success checks

- Describe both the initial selection and unaided recovery.
- Avoid claiming either flawless use or universal failure.
- Agree to use the study definitions and retain the full observed sequence.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to omit the first selection because the final screen was correct.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Request a pathway assessment, not a presumed route

Fictional submission planning: a slide presents the proposed device pathway as settled, although regulatory specialists are still evaluating options.

01 • Project manager: The slide presents our proposed pathway as settled. What confirmation should I request before using it?

02 • Regulatory lead: Ask for the current assessment, supporting assumptions, and unresolved questions from the regulatory team.

03 • Project manager: Could I leave 510(k) as confirmed because it is already printed in the timeline?

04 • Regulatory lead: No. A planning label doesn't establish that route or an agency outcome.

05 • Project manager: What specific action do you need from the product team for the assessment?

06 • Regulatory lead: Please confirm the current device description and intended use before our internal review meeting.

07 • Project manager: Should the slide list De Novo and PMA as equally appropriate alternatives while review continues?

08 • Regulatory lead: Not unless assessed. We can say pathway under evaluation without inventing a ranking or conclusion.

09 • Project manager: I'll correct the status and send the requested product information for review.

10 • Regulatory lead: I'll return a scoped assessment and identify which questions need further specialist or agency clarification.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A similar product is not a confirmed predicate

Separate fictional regulatory exercise: a competitor's brochure describes a superficially similar device; no predicate assessment has been completed.

01 • Commercial manager: This brochure looks similar to our device. Can we identify it as our confirmed predicate?

02 • Regulatory specialist: Not from the brochure alone. We need the relevant device information and a regulatory assessment.

03 • Commercial manager: What can I request from our research team before tomorrow's strategy discussion?

04 • Regulatory specialist: Ask for the source documents supporting the comparison, including the device identity and intended-use information.

05 • Commercial manager: Would sharing the same marketing category prove suitability for a 510(k) strategy?

06 • Regulatory specialist: No. A marketing category is not a completed predicate-device analysis.

07 • Commercial manager: I'll call it a candidate for assessment rather than a selected predicate in the briefing.

08 • Regulatory specialist: Please also identify gaps instead of filling missing technical characteristics from appearance or promotional language.

09 • Commercial manager: I'll send the documented comparison questions today and request an initial review status.

10 • Regulatory specialist: I'll assess what is available and explain the next evidence needs without promising a pathway conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A design change needs a scoped regulatory question

Separate fictional planning call: a team proposes changing the device's intended user group; regulatory implications have not been reviewed.

01 • Development director: Can the regulatory team confirm that this user-group change has no submission implications?

02 • Regulatory strategist: Please frame it as an assessment request, not a request to endorse an assumed answer.

03 • Development director: What information would make the request focused enough for the team to act?

04 • Regulatory strategist: Provide the current and proposed user groups, intended tasks, and the related design-change description.

05 • Development director: Could we assume the original pathway remains unchanged because the hardware isn't changing?

06 • Regulatory strategist: We shouldn't infer that. The intended-use context needs review even if the hardware description stays the same.

07 • Development director: I'll request the assessment before we finalize the project plan, with the changes clearly compared.

08 • Regulatory strategist: Good. Ask for an initial scope and timing estimate rather than an immediate blanket assurance.

09 • Development director: I'll leave the pathway implications open and avoid making a 510(k), De Novo, or PMA claim.

10 • Regulatory strategist: I'll coordinate the relevant review and return the verified planning implications when the assessment is available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Regulatory Pathways and Submissions

A presentation refers to a proposed device pathway as settled, although the regulatory team is still evaluating options.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Please label the pathway as under evaluation and identify the questions for the regulatory team. We should distinguish a proposed approach from a confirmed regulatory conclusion.

Scenario 2 | A submission date confused with an outcome date

A fictional project calendar targets submission on 1 October. No review duration or agency decision date is confirmed. A launch slide calls 1 October the clearance date. Request a correction and a scoped regulatory planning review.

Role A: Program coordinator: identify the calendar mismatch and request accurate wording.

Role B: Regulatory manager: distinguish a planned submission from an unconfirmed agency outcome.

Possible opening: October first is our submission target, not a confirmed clearance date.

Success checks

- Separate the team's filing target from agency decision timing.
- Request correction of the specific claim.
- Agree the review owner without inventing a regulatory timeline.

Add a complication: Sales asks to keep the date because customers have already seen the draft.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A malfunction complaint with missing identifiers

Fictional complaint handoff: a malfunction is reported, but the device identifier and event date are missing; no reportability assessment exists.

01 • Customer support specialist: I'm handing over a reported malfunction; the device identifier and event date are still missing.

02 • Complaint investigator: Please pass the available account now through our complaint channel and label those gaps explicitly.

03 • Customer support specialist: Should I wait until the reporter provides both details before you receive the complaint?

04 • Complaint investigator: Don't delay this handoff for completeness. Follow our process for transferring known facts and requesting follow-up.

05 • Customer support specialist: Can I label it a confirmed MDR event to make the urgency clear?

06 • Complaint investigator: No reportability assessment is established here. Keep the complaint description separate from that authorized determination.

07 • Customer support specialist: I'll preserve the reporter's wording and avoid inventing the model or event date.

08 • Complaint investigator: I'll take ownership of investigation intake and coordinate the missing-information request.

09 • Customer support specialist: Please confirm that your team received the handoff so I don't assume responsibility transferred.

10 • Complaint investigator: Confirmed. We'll assess the available facts and keep the unresolved identifier, date, and reporting questions visible.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A second report may describe the same event

Separate fictional postmarket case: distributor and clinic reports mention the same device reference and date; whether they describe one event or two is unconfirmed.

01 • Postmarket analyst: We received two reports with the same device reference and date. I'm flagging a possible duplicate.

02 • Complaint coordinator: Have you confirmed that they describe one event rather than separate malfunctions?

03 • Postmarket analyst: No. The matching details suggest a check, but they don't establish duplication by themselves.

04 • Complaint coordinator: Please link both reports for review without deleting either account from the record.

05 • Postmarket analyst: Should the surveillance count show two confirmed events while the check is pending?

06 • Complaint coordinator: Distinguish reports received from verified event count so the uncertainty isn't hidden.

07 • Postmarket analyst: I'll hand over both source references and identify which details match.

08 • Complaint coordinator: I'll own the reconciliation and route any reporting assessment through the responsible team.

09 • Postmarket analyst: Can you return the verified relationship before I finalize the postmarket surveillance summary?

10 • Complaint coordinator: Yes. I'll report the reconciliation status without assuming either duplication or two independent events in advance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A returned device does not complete the investigation

Separate fictional complaint case: the returned device has arrived at the laboratory, but examination and causality review have not started.

01 • Service coordinator: The returned device arrived this morning. I'm transferring the case to the investigation laboratory.

02 • Investigation engineer: Thank you. Receipt is confirmed, but examination and any causal assessment are still pending.

03 • Service coordinator: Could customer support say the reported malfunction has been verified now that we have the device?

04 • Investigation engineer: No. Possession of the device isn't confirmation of the reported behavior or its cause.

05 • Service coordinator: I'll pass the complaint reference and maintain the distinction between receipt and examination.

06 • Investigation engineer: Please include the available custody information through the case system so the handoff is traceable.

07 • Service coordinator: Who will return an update for the customer's next inquiry about investigation progress?

08 • Investigation engineer: I'll own the laboratory status update, while the complaint team retains its overall coordination role.

09 • Service coordinator: I'll tell support the device is received and assessment remains pending, without predicting findings.

10 • Investigation engineer: Correct. I'll confirm the next verified status and keep any MDR assessment with the authorized reporting team.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Complaints, MDRs, and Postmarket Signals

A complaint report describes a malfunction but lacks the device identifier and event date. The complaint-handling team needs the available facts promptly.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Here is the reported malfunction and the information currently available. The device identifier and event date are missing. Please confirm receipt and handle follow-up through the complaint process.

Scenario 2 | A reporter changes the device reference

In a fictional complaint case, the reporter withdraws the original device reference and supplies a photo that has not been reviewed. The correct identifier remains unconfirmed. Hand the correction to the complaint team without overwriting the history.

Role A: Technical support specialist: distinguish the withdrawn identifier from the unreviewed photo.

Role B: Complaint coordinator: confirm receipt and assign identifier verification.

Possible opening: The reporter says the original reference was wrong; the photo may help, but its identifier has not been verified.

Success checks

- Do not guess the device identity.
- Preserve the correction and source history.
- Confirm the owner of verification and keep reportability decisions separate.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests entering the most common model as a temporary fact.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two nonconforming lots still await disposition

Fictional incoming-material review: two lots are identified as nonconforming; investigation is open and disposition is unauthorized.

01 • Production planner: Two lots were inspected. Can I show the incoming-material issue as resolved on the schedule?

02 • Supplier quality engineer: No. Both lots are identified as nonconforming, and the investigation and disposition remain open.

03 • Production planner: The inspection is finished, though. What completed work can I accurately report?

04 • Supplier quality engineer: The nonconformance was identified in two lots. That doesn't establish authorization to use or release them.

05 • Production planner: Should I assume the supplier CAPA is complete because we've sent them the findings?

06 • Supplier quality engineer: No. Sending findings is a communication step, not evidence of completed corrective action.

07 • Production planner: I'll keep material availability unconfirmed and ask for the next investigation update.

08 • Supplier quality engineer: Please preserve the two lot references so the planning discussion maintains lot traceability.

09 • Production planner: I'll link the records and avoid substituting another lot without a separate verified decision.

10 • Supplier quality engineer: I'll communicate any authorized status change and distinguish it from our ongoing assessment activities.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A supplier response is not an accepted CAPA

Separate fictional quality case: a supplier submitted a corrective-action response for lot D12, but the receiving quality team has not reviewed it.

01 • Procurement lead: The supplier sent its CAPA response for D12. Can I mark the issue closed?

02 • Quality reviewer: Receipt is complete, but our review and any acceptance decision are still pending.

03 • Procurement lead: They wrote resolved in the response. Doesn't that settle the status for our dashboard?

04 • Quality reviewer: That is the supplier's statement, not a completed assessment by the responsible receiving team.

05 • Procurement lead: What distinction should I communicate to production while the review continues?

06 • Quality reviewer: Supplier response received, assessment pending, and no new material-use authorization established by this exchange.

07 • Procurement lead: I'll retain the response against the nonconformance record rather than replace our status with their wording.

08 • Quality reviewer: Good. Keep lot traceability so the response isn't accidentally applied to unrelated material.

09 • Procurement lead: Can you provide a review-status checkpoint once an owner has confirmed the work?

10 • Quality reviewer: Yes. I'll report the verified next step without treating a supplier declaration as proof of effectiveness or closure.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Process trials complete, validation review pending

Separate fictional manufacturing update: three planned process trials have been executed, but the process-validation report has not been reviewed.

01 • Manufacturing manager: All three trials ran. Can the status slide say the process is validated?

02 • Validation engineer: Execution is complete, but the process-validation report still awaits review.

03 • Manufacturing manager: Would changing the phrase to fully tested avoid that approval issue?

04 • Validation engineer: It could still overstate the scope. Say the three planned trials were executed, with review pending.

05 • Manufacturing manager: Do we have a confirmed conclusion about acceptance criteria from the information supplied here?

06 • Validation engineer: No. We should not invent a pass, a failure, or an authorized manufacturing decision.

07 • Manufacturing manager: I'll distinguish completed trial activity from the unconfirmed assessment and its production implications.

08 • Validation engineer: Please keep the material and lot references available so the trial evidence remains traceable.

09 • Manufacturing manager: I'll ask for the next review checkpoint rather than promise routine production availability.

10 • Validation engineer: I'll provide that status when confirmed and identify any remaining evidence needs without announcing an outcome prematurely.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Manufacturing, Suppliers, and Nonconformance

An incoming-material review has identified two nonconforming lots. The investigation is open and disposition has not been authorized.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: Two lots have open nonconformance records. The investigation and disposition are still pending. I'll report their status without implying that release or rejection has already been approved.

Scenario 2 | A lot reference missing from the inspection attachment

A fictional inspection summary says one lot passed, but its attached measurement sheet has no lot reference. The linkage is unverified and no new release decision is supplied. Explain completed work and the unresolved traceability question.

Role A: Incoming inspector: report the missing linkage without assuming the measurements belong to the stated lot.

Role B: Quality coordinator: assign verification and keep the status appropriately qualified.

Possible opening: The summary names a lot, but we have not verified that this measurement sheet belongs to it.

Success checks

- Identify the precise lot-traceability gap.
- Do not assign evidence by guesswork.
- Agree the verification owner without implying release authority.

Add a complication: A planner asks you to attach the sheet to the nearest lot number in the system.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A demonstration outside the session materials

Fictional clinical-training session: a trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the approved session materials; no procedure is taught in this language exercise.

01 • Clinical trainer: That requested demonstration is outside the materials approved for this session.

02 • Training coordinator: Could you show it briefly and say it isn't part of the standard training?

03 • Clinical trainer: My concern is that the demonstration would still go beyond our reviewed scope and supporting instructions.

04 • Training coordinator: What can we offer so the question is acknowledged rather than simply dismissed?

05 • Clinical trainer: Capture the specific inquiry and refer it through the appropriate medical or regulatory review channel.

06 • Training coordinator: Does calling it off-label mean we can answer freely as long as we use that term?

07 • Clinical trainer: No. The label doesn't itself establish an appropriate response or the clinical evidence needed.

08 • Training coordinator: I'll keep today's practice within the supplied instructions for use and flag the separate question.

09 • Clinical trainer: Thank you. We should not improvise a clinical technique or claim outside the reviewed materials.

10 • Training coordinator: I'll confirm the referral owner and avoid promising that the requested demonstration will be approved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An older training deck conflicts with the current packet

Separate fictional training review: an older deck contains a step absent from the current approved session packet; the reason for the difference is unknown.

01 • Training manager: The older deck includes an extra step. Could we add it back to make today's session familiar?

02 • Clinical education specialist: We need the discrepancy reviewed first. Familiarity doesn't establish that the older step belongs in this session.

03 • Training manager: Can we assume it was removed accidentally rather than as an intentional labeling change?

04 • Clinical education specialist: Neither explanation is confirmed. Preserve both references and ask the responsible owner to clarify.

05 • Training manager: What should the trainer do while the packet difference is unresolved?

06 • Clinical education specialist: Keep to the verified session scope and avoid improvising the disputed content.

07 • Training manager: I'll request a comparison with the applicable instructions for use before revising the deck.

08 • Clinical education specialist: Good. A training edit should not silently create a new instruction or broader use claim.

09 • Training manager: I'll tell the trainer the extra step is under review, not confirmed as correct or incorrect.

10 • Clinical education specialist: I'll coordinate the clarification and return reviewed wording rather than let the team choose between versions informally.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A testimonial is not comparative clinical evidence

Separate fictional education-material review: a slide says the device is safer than alternatives based only on one clinician's favorable comment.

01 • Sales educator: The clinician praised the device. Can our training slide say it is safer than alternatives?

02 • Clinical evidence reviewer: That comparative safety claim goes beyond a single favorable comment and needs appropriate supporting evidence.

03 • Sales educator: Could we place the comment in quotation marks and keep the same safety headline?

04 • Clinical evidence reviewer: Quotation marks don't supply evidence for the headline. We need to assess the actual claim.

05 • Sales educator: What can I use for the session while that assessment is pending?

06 • Clinical evidence reviewer: Stay within the reviewed labeling and session materials, and route the proposed comparison for review.

07 • Sales educator: Should I describe the absence of evidence here as proof the device is less safe?

08 • Clinical evidence reviewer: No. Neither comparative conclusion is established by the supplied comment.

09 • Sales educator: I'll remove the unsupported headline and keep the clinician's comment out of this draft pending review.

10 • Clinical evidence reviewer: I'll assess the proposed content and clarify the evidence boundary without promising approval of a comparative claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clinical Training and Labeling Boundaries

A trainer is asked to demonstrate a use beyond the materials approved for the session.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want to move quickly and initially overlook a relevant condition. Ask why it matters, then consider a practical route forward that respects the real constraint.

Second round: The other person repeats the request more firmly. Restate the specific concern calmly and explain the appropriate next route.

Model for scenario 1: That request goes beyond the approved training material for this session. I can cover the authorized instructions and route the additional question to the appropriate team for review.

Scenario 2 | A requested shortcut to fit the training slot

A fictional coordinator asks a trainer to omit one section from the approved device-training packet to finish ten minutes earlier. The section's purpose and omission implications have not been assessed. Negotiate a review of timing without changing the instructions yourself.

Role A: Clinical trainer: explain the scope concern and propose checking an approved shorter session format.

Role B: Training coordinator: describe the timing constraint and agree to obtain the responsible review.

Possible opening: I can discuss the timing, but I can't assume this section can be omitted without review.

Success checks

- Avoid assuming experience removes the need for reviewed content.
- Keep the session within authorized materials.
- Agree a practical timing or review route without improvising device instructions.

Add a complication: The organizer says experienced participants never need the omitted material.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

FDA: De Novo classification

<https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/premarket-submissions-selecting-and-preparing-correct-submission/de-novo-classification-request>

FDA: Medical Device Reporting

<https://www.fda.gov/medical-devices/medical-device-safety/medical-device-reporting-mdr-how-report-medical-device-problems>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Medical Devices English

Professional audience: medical device engineers, product managers, quality and regulatory staff, clinical specialists, manufacturing teams, field-service teams, and device-company leaders

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Dialogue 01: User need to design input

Original fictional setting: A device team reviews a vague usability requirement.

Professional roles: Product manager / Systems engineer

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Product manager: Users want the display to be readable at a glance. How do we turn that into a design input?

Systems engineer: Define the intended users, viewing conditions, information, and a measurable acceptance criterion.

Product manager: Can we reuse the criterion from our desktop product?

Systems engineer: Not without checking the use environment. This device will be used under different lighting and workflow conditions.

Product manager: I'll bring those user-research findings to the requirements review.

Systems engineer: Then we can agree on traceable inputs and an appropriate verification approach.

Vocabulary in this exchange: design input: A documented requirement that guides a product's design. / verification: Checking whether specified requirements have been met.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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Product manager: I'll bring those user-research findings to the requirements review.

Systems engineer: Then we can agree on traceable inputs and an appropriate verification approach.

Vocabulary in this exchange: design input: A documented requirement that guides a product's design. / verification: Checking whether specified requirements have been met.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level